



Devanāgarī Handwriting Practice Book

अ आ क ख ग

Model Trace Copy Repeat

PRINTABLE PENCIL EDITION

For children, families, classrooms, and adult beginners. Includes every core Classical Sanskrit letter, vowel signs, common conjuncts, basic words, Devanāgarī digits, and generous repetition space.

How to use this book

Short, calm practice builds stronger letter memory.

1

Model

Say the IAST sound. Look at the whole printed form and its proportions.

2

Trace

Move slowly over each pale model. Accuracy matters more than speed.

3

Copy

Look back at the model, then write in the guided cells.

4

Repeat

Cover the model if possible. Retrieve the shape from memory.

A GOOD PRACTICE SESSION

5 minutes: warm-up lines and curves.

10 minutes: one new letter page.

5 minutes: review one earlier page from memory.

Stop before the hand becomes tense. Frequent short sessions are better than one exhausting session.

Pencil, paper, and posture

Comfort first: clear writing comes from controlled, relaxed movement.

PENCIL GRIP

Hold the pencil gently between thumb and index finger, supported by the middle finger. Keep the fingers a short distance from the tip.

PAPER ANGLE

Turn the paper slightly so the writing hand can move naturally. A right-handed and left-handed learner may prefer opposite angles.

POSTURE

Sit with feet supported, shoulders relaxed, and forearms resting comfortably. Keep the page close enough to see without bending low.

PRESSURE

Use light-to-medium pressure. The pale trace models should remain visible under the pencil line, not be carved into the paper.

HEADLINE

Align the śirorekḥā, or headline, with the upper guide. In many teaching styles the main body is formed first and the headline is completed last.

LOCAL CONVENTION

Stroke order can vary slightly by teacher and handwriting tradition. Follow a local teacher's demonstrated order when it differs, while preserving the printed proportions.

ADULT SUPERVISION

For young children, use an age-appropriate pencil and supervise practice. Praise careful observation and relaxed movement, not only perfect results.

Straight paths

Build control for headlines, stems, and diagonals.



Continue the pattern



Continue the pattern



Continue the pattern



Continue the pattern



Continue the pattern



Continue the pattern

MOVEMENT CHECK

Move from the shoulder and wrist as needed. Keep speed slow, spacing even, and pencil pressure light.

Curves and turns

Build control for bowls, shoulders, hooks, and loops.

⌋ ⌋ ⌋ ⌋ ⌋ -----
Continue the pattern

⌋ ⌋ ⌋ ⌋ ⌋ -----
Continue the pattern

⌋ ⌋ ⌋ ⌋ ⌋ -----
Continue the pattern

⌋ ⌋ ⌋ ⌋ ⌋ -----
Continue the pattern

⌋ ⌋ ⌋ ⌋ ⌋ -----
Continue the pattern

⌋ ⌋ ⌋ ⌋ ⌋ -----
Continue the pattern

MOVEMENT CHECK

Move from the shoulder and wrist as needed. Keep speed slow, spacing even, and pencil pressure light.

Headline rhythm

Practice body shapes, verticals, and a steady śirorekḥā.

TTTTT

Continue the pattern

rrrrr

Continue the pattern

TTTTT

Continue the pattern

rrrrr

Continue the pattern

TTTTT

Continue the pattern

rrrrr

Continue the pattern

MOVEMENT CHECK

Move from the shoulder and wrist as needed. Keep speed slow, spacing even, and pencil pressure light.

Independent vowels

IAST first, Devanāgarī beside it.

अ a	आ ā	इ i	ई ī
उ u	ऊ ū	ऋ ṛ	ॠ ṝ
ऌ ḷ	ॡ ṳ	ए e	ऐ ai
ओ o	औ au		

HOW TO READ THE MAP

Long vowels use a macron: ā ī ū. Dots and accents in IAST distinguish different Sanskrit sounds; they are not optional decorations.

Consonants by sound group

Each full consonant letter includes an inherent short a.

क ka	ख kha	ग ga	घ gha	ङ ṅa
च ca	छ cha	ज ja	झ jha	ञ ña
ट ṭa	ठ ṭha	ड ḍa	ढ ḍha	ण ṇa
त ta	थ tha	द da	ध dha	न na
प pa	फ pha	ब ba	भ bha	म ma
य ya	र ra	ल la	व va	श śa
ष ṣa	स sa	ह ha	ळ ḷa	

HOW TO READ THE MAP

Long vowels use a macron: ā ī ū. Dots and accents in IAST distinguish different Sanskrit sounds; they are not optional decorations.

Independent vowels



A vowel can stand alone as a full letter. Say the IAST sound first, then trace the Devanāgarī form.

अ आ इ ई

Before you begin

- Long vowels are held longer: ā, ī, ū, ṛ.
- Trace the whole printed model before trying to write from memory.
- Keep the body proportionate and align any headline with the guide.

INDEPENDENT VOWELS

a • अ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

VOWEL		Sound cue: short a A relaxed central vowel; keep the body open and balanced.
a	अ	

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

अ	अ	अ	अ	अ	अ
अ	अ	अ	अ	अ	अ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ā • आ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

VOWEL		Sound cue: long ā
ā	आ	Hold the vowel about twice as long as a.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

आ	आ	आ	आ	आ	आ
आ	आ	आ	आ	आ	आ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

INDEPENDENT VOWELS

i • इ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

VOWEL i 	Sound cue: short i Keep the upper curve distinct from the lower body.
---	---

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

इ	इ	इ	इ	इ	इ
इ	इ	इ	इ	इ	इ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

INDEPENDENT VOWELS

ī • ई

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

VOWEL		Sound cue: long ī
ī		Notice the extra upper movement; do not crowd the headline.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

u • उ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

VOWEL		Sound cue: short u Let the lower curve descend clearly below the body.
u	उ	

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

उ	उ	उ	उ	उ	उ
उ	उ	उ	उ	उ	उ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ū • ऊ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

VOWEL		Sound cue: long ū Keep both lower movements open and easy to see.
ū	ऊ	

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ऊ	ऊ	ऊ	ऊ	ऊ	ऊ
ऊ	ऊ	ऊ	ऊ	ऊ	ऊ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

r • ऋ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

VOWEL

r

ऋ

Sound cue: vocalic r

Use the full independent-vowel shape, not a consonant plus a sign.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ऋ	ऋ	ऋ	ऋ	ऋ	ऋ
ऋ	ऋ	ऋ	ऋ	ऋ	ऋ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ī · ऋ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

VOWEL

ī

ऋ

Sound cue: long vocalic ī

A less common Classical Sanskrit vowel; copy its full form carefully.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ऋ	ऋ	ऋ	ऋ	ऋ	ऋ
ऋ	ऋ	ऋ	ऋ	ऋ	ऋ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

INDEPENDENT VOWELS

३. लृ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

VOWEL

३

लृ

Sound cue: vocalic ३

A rare Sanskrit vowel; keep its distinctive lower detail.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

लृ	लृ	लृ	लृ	लृ	लृ
लृ	लृ	लृ	लृ	लृ	लृ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

INDEPENDENT VOWELS

ī • लृ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

VOWEL

ī

लृ

Sound cue: long vocalic ī

A very rare extension; learn it for alphabet completeness.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

लृ	लृ	लृ	लृ	लृ	लृ
लृ	लृ	लृ	लृ	लृ	लृ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

INDEPENDENT VOWELS

e • ए

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

VOWEL e 	Sound cue: long e Keep the upper diagonal and headline separate and crisp.
---	--

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ए	ए	ए	ए	ए	ए
ए	ए	ए	ए	ए	ए

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ai · ऐ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

VOWEL		Sound cue: diphthong ai The additional upper mark distinguishes ai from e.
ai		

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ऐ	ऐ	ऐ	ऐ	ऐ	ऐ
ऐ	ऐ	ऐ	ऐ	ऐ	ऐ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

o • ओ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

VOWEL o ओ	Sound cue: long o Keep the right-side stroke aligned and evenly spaced.
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1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ओ	ओ	ओ	ओ	ओ	ओ
ओ	ओ	ओ	ओ	ओ	ओ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

au · औ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

VOWEL		Sound cue: diphthong au The extra upper mark distinguishes au from o.
au	औ	

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

औ	औ	औ	औ	औ	औ
औ	औ	औ	औ	औ	औ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

Sound marks

These marks modify a sound or punctuate Sanskrit text.

am̐

अं

anusvāra ṁ

A nasal marker; its pronunciation adapts to the following sound.

aḥ

अः

visarga ḥ

A breath-like sound after the vowel.

am̐̃

अँ

candrabindu m̐̃

Marks vowel nasalization; especially useful in Vedic and some lexical contexts.

'

ऽ

avagraha

Marks the loss of an initial a after sandhi.

.

। ॥

danda and double danda

Traditional sentence and verse punctuation.

Trace the signs

Move slowly

•	ः	ँ	ऽ	।
॥	•	ः	ँ	।



Consonants

A full Devanāgarī consonant letter normally includes an inherent short a. The sound groups move from the back of the mouth toward the lips.

क च ट त प

Before you begin

- Say ka, kha, ga... rather than isolated English letter names.
- Keep aspirated and unaspirated partners distinct.
- Distinguish retroflex ṭ/ḍ/ṇ from dental t/d/n.

ka · क

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT	ka क	Sound cue: k in skate Unaspirated: use little extra breath.
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1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

क	क	क	क	क	क
क	क	क	क	क	क

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

kha • ख

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

kha

ख

Sound cue: k plus breath

Aspirated partner of ka; keep the loop open.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ख	ख	ख	ख	ख	ख
ख	ख	ख	ख	ख	ख

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ga • ग

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

ga

ग

Sound cue: g in go

Voiced; keep the lower curve rounded.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ग	ग	ग	ग	ग	ग
ग	ग	ग	ग	ग	ग

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

gha · घ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

gha

घ

Sound cue: g plus breath

Voiced and aspirated; separate the inner turns.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

घ	घ	घ	घ	घ	घ
घ	घ	घ	घ	घ	घ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ṅa • ङ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

ṅa

ङ

Sound cue: ng in sing

A nasal; used mainly in consonant combinations.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ङ	ङ	ङ	ङ	ङ	ङ
ङ	ङ	ङ	ङ	ङ	ङ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ca • च

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT	ca च	Sound cue: ch in church IAST c represents this unaspirated sound.
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1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

च	च	च	च	च	च
च	च	च	च	च	च

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

cha · छ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

cha



Sound cue: ch plus breath

Aspirated partner of ca.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

छ	छ	छ	छ	छ	छ
छ	छ	छ	छ	छ	छ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ja • ज

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

ja

ज

Sound cue: j in joy

Keep the lower bowl open and the stem straight.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ज	ज	ज	ज	ज	ज
ज	ज	ज	ज	ज	ज

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

jha • झ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

jha

झ

Sound cue: j plus breath

Voiced and aspirated; do not lose the inner detail.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

झ	झ	झ	झ	झ	झ
झ	झ	झ	झ	झ	झ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ña • ज

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

ña

ज

Sound cue: ny in canyon

A nasal; common inside conjuncts.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ज	ज	ज	ज	ज	ज
ज	ज	ज	ज	ज	ज

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ṭa • ट

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

ṭa

ट

Sound cue: retroflex t

Curl the tongue back; keep the written bowl compact.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ट	ट	ट	ट	ट	ट
ट	ट	ट	ट	ट	ट

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ṭha · ṭ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

ṭha



Sound cue: retroflex t plus breath

Aspirated partner of ṭa.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

					
					

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ḍa · ङ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

ḍa

ङ

Sound cue: retroflex d

Voiced; keep the rounded body below the headline.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ङ	ङ	ङ	ङ	ङ	ङ
ङ	ङ	ङ	ङ	ङ	ङ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ḍha • ढ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

ḍha

ढ

Sound cue: retroflex d plus breath

Keep the lower extension clear.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ढ	ढ	ढ	ढ	ढ	ढ
ढ	ढ	ढ	ढ	ढ	ढ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ṇa · ण

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

ṇa

ण

Sound cue: retroflex n

Differentiate it carefully from na.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ण	ण	ण	ण	ण	ण
ण	ण	ण	ण	ण	ण

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ta • त

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

ta

त

Sound cue: dental t

Touch the tongue near the upper teeth; keep the hook light.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

त	त	त	त	त	त
त	त	त	त	त	त

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

tha • थ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

tha

थ

Sound cue: dental t plus breath

Aspirated partner of ta.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

थ	थ	थ	थ	थ	थ
थ	थ	थ	थ	थ	थ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

da · द

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

da

द

Sound cue: dental d

Keep the left curve and right stem in proportion.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

द	द	द	द	द	द
द	द	द	द	द	द

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

dha • ধ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

dha

ধ

Sound cue: dental d plus breath

Do not close the lower inner space.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ধ	ধ	ধ	ধ	ধ	ধ
ধ	ধ	ধ	ধ	ধ	ধ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

na · न

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

na

न

Sound cue: n in no

Keep the stem vertical and the lower turn smooth.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

न	न	न	न	न	न
न	न	न	न	न	न

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

pa • प

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

pa

प

Sound cue: p in spin

Unaspirated; keep both verticals steady.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

प	प	प	प	प	प
प	प	प	प	प	प

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

pha · फ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

pha

फ

Sound cue: p plus breath

Classical Sanskrit ph is aspirated p, not English f.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

फ	फ	फ	फ	फ	फ
फ	फ	फ	फ	फ	फ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ba • ब

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT		Sound cue: b in boy Keep the lower loop open.
ba	ब	

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ब	ब	ब	ब	ब	ब
ब	ब	ब	ब	ब	ब

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

bha · भ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

bha

भ

Sound cue: b plus breath

Voiced and aspirated; leave room for the inner curve.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

भ	भ	भ	भ	भ	भ
भ	भ	भ	भ	भ	भ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ma • म

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

ma

म

Sound cue: m in mother

Keep the two lower shoulders even.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

म	म	म	म	म	म
म	म	म	म	म	म

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ya • य

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

ya

य

Sound cue: y in yes

Make the lower curve light and the stem straight.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

य	य	य	य	य	य
य	य	य	य	य	य

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ra • र

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

ra

र

Sound cue: flapped or rolled r

This full form differs from repha and other conjunct forms.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

र	र	र	र	र	र
र	र	र	र	र	र

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

la • ल

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

la

ल

Sound cue: l in light

Keep the tall stem straight and lower loop clear.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ल	ल	ल	ल	ल	ल
ल	ल	ल	ल	ल	ल

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

va • व

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT va व	Sound cue: between v and w Keep the lower bowl distinct from ba.
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1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

व	व	व	व	व	व
व	व	व	व	व	व

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

śa • श

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

śa

श

Sound cue: palatal sh

IAST acute ś; keep all three lower elements distinct.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

श	श	श	श	श	श
श	श	श	श	श	श

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ṣa • ष

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

ṣa

ष

Sound cue: retroflex sh

IAST dotted ṣ; distinguish it from śa and sa.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ष	ष	ष	ष	ष	ष
ष	ष	ष	ष	ष	ष

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

sa • स

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

sa

स

Sound cue: s in sun

Keep the upper turn and lower body open.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

स	स	स	स	स	स
स	स	स	स	स	स

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ha · ह

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

ha**ह****Sound cue: h in ahead**

Let the left body remain broad enough to read.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ह	ह	ह	ह	ह	ह
ह	ह	ह	ह	ह	ह

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

la · ऌ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

la

Sound cue: retroflex l

A supplementary regional/Sanskrit letter; not in every basic alphabet.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

Vowel signs



After a consonant, most vowels are written with dependent signs called mātrās. The inherent a uses no separate sign.

क का की कि

Before you begin

- Read the complete syllable, not the sign by itself.
- The i sign appears visually before the consonant but is pronounced after it.
- Lower and upper signs must remain attached to the correct consonant.

kā · का

Add the ā sign to ka. The consonant and sign form one written unit.

BUILD THE SYLLABLE

right-side vertical

ka + ā kā क ा का

1. Trace

12 complete syllables

का	का	का	का	का	का
का	का	का	का	का	का

2. Copy

Place the sign precisely

3. Repeat

18 spaces

ki • कि

Add the i sign to ka. The consonant and sign form one written unit.

BUILD THE SYLLABLE

ka + i ki

क कि

written before the consonant but
pronounced after it

1. Trace

12 complete syllables

कि	कि	कि	कि	कि	कि
कि	कि	कि	कि	कि	कि

2. Copy

Place the sign precisely

3. Repeat

18 spaces

kī • की

Add the ī sign to ka. The consonant and sign form one written unit.

BUILD THE SYLLABLE

ka + ī kī

क ी की

right-side long i sign

1. Trace

12 complete syllables

की	की	की	की	की	की
की	की	की	की	की	की

2. Copy

Place the sign precisely

3. Repeat

18 spaces

ku · कु

Add the u sign to ka. The consonant and sign form one written unit.

BUILD THE SYLLABLE

short lower sign

ka + u ku

कु कु

1. Trace

12 complete syllables

कु	कु	कु	कु	कु	कु
कु	कु	कु	कु	कु	कु

2. Copy

Place the sign precisely

3. Repeat

18 spaces

kū · कू

Add the ū sign to ka. The consonant and sign form one written unit.

BUILD THE SYLLABLE

long lower sign

ka + ū kū कू कू

1. Trace

12 complete syllables

कू	कू	कू	कू	कू	कू
कू	कू	कू	कू	कू	कू

2. Copy

Place the sign precisely

3. Repeat

18 spaces

kr · कृ

Add the ृ sign to ka. The consonant and sign form one written unit.

BUILD THE SYLLABLE

lower vocalic-r sign

ka + ृ kr

कृ कृ

1. Trace

12 complete syllables

कृ	कृ	कृ	कृ	कृ	कृ
कृ	कृ	कृ	कृ	कृ	कृ

2. Copy

Place the sign precisely

3. Repeat

18 spaces

kṛ · कृ

Add the ṛ sign to ka. The consonant and sign form one written unit.

BUILD THE SYLLABLE

long vocalic-r sign

ka + ṛ kṛ क कृ

1. Trace

12 complete syllables

कृ	कृ	कृ	कृ	कृ	कृ
कृ	कृ	कृ	कृ	कृ	कृ

2. Copy

Place the sign precisely

3. Repeat

18 spaces

kl · क॒

Add the | sign to ka. The consonant and sign form one written unit.

BUILD THE SYLLABLE

rare lower vocalic-l sign

ka + l kl

क॒ क॒

1. Trace

12 complete syllables

क॒	क॒	क॒	क॒	क॒	क॒
क॒	क॒	क॒	क॒	क॒	क॒

2. Copy

Place the sign precisely

3. Repeat

18 spaces

kī · क

Add the ī sign to ka. The consonant and sign form one written unit.

BUILD THE SYLLABLE

rare long vocalic-ī sign

ka + ī kī

क क

1. Trace

12 complete syllables

क	क	क	क	क	क
क	क	क	क	क	क

2. Copy

Place the sign precisely

3. Repeat

18 spaces

ke • के

Add the e sign to ka. The consonant and sign form one written unit.

BUILD THE SYLLABLE

ka + e ke क[े] के

upper sign

1. Trace

12 complete syllables

के	के	के	के	के	के
के	के	के	के	के	के

2. Copy

Place the sign precisely

3. Repeat

18 spaces

kai · कै

Add the ai sign to ka. The consonant and sign form one written unit.

BUILD THE SYLLABLE

ka + ai kai क कै

double upper sign

1. Trace

12 complete syllables

कै	कै	कै	कै	कै	कै
कै	कै	कै	कै	कै	कै

2. Copy

Place the sign precisely

3. Repeat

18 spaces

ko • को

Add the o sign to ka. The consonant and sign form one written unit.

BUILD THE SYLLABLE

ka + o ko

क े को

upper plus right-side sign

1. Trace

12 complete syllables

को	को	को	को	को	को
को	को	को	को	को	को

2. Copy

Place the sign precisely

3. Repeat

18 spaces

kau • कौ

Add the au sign to ka. The consonant and sign form one written unit.

BUILD THE SYLLABLE

ka + au kau क कै कौ

upper plus right-side au sign

1. Trace

12 complete syllables

कौ	कौ	कौ	कौ	कौ	कौ
कौ	कौ	कौ	कौ	कौ	कौ

2. Copy

Place the sign precisely

3. Repeat

18 spaces

Virāma and inherent a

A consonant letter normally carries a short a unless a sign or virāma changes it.

SIGN

k

क्

Sound cue: consonant without inherent a

Place the virāma neatly below the consonant.

1. Trace k

12 repetitions

क्	क्	क्	क्	क्	क्
क्	क्	क्	क्	क्	क्

2. Alternate ka / k

Notice the final mark

क	क्	क	क्	क	क्
क	क्	क	क्	क	क्

3. Write from memory

ka, k, ka, k ...

COMPARE

ka क contains the inherent short a. **k क्** uses the virāma or halant् to suppress that vowel. In normal Sanskrit writing, consonant clusters often form conjunct shapes rather than displaying a separate visible virāma.



Common conjuncts

When one consonant follows another without an intervening vowel, their written forms often combine. Learn frequent clusters as recognizable units.

क्ष त्र ज्ञ श्र

Before you begin

- Say both consonant values even when the written form changes strongly.
- Notice which consonant loses part of its full form.
- Use the same model-trace-copy-repeat routine.

kṣa • क्ष

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONJUNCT

kṣa

क्ष

Sound cue: क् + ष

A common cluster in words such as kṣetra.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

क्ष	क्ष	क्ष	क्ष	क्ष	क्ष
क्ष	क्ष	क्ष	क्ष	क्ष	क्ष

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

tra • त्र

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONJUNCT

tra

त्र

Sound cue: त् + र

A common cluster in words such as mitra.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

त्र	त्र	त्र	त्र	त्र	त्र
त्र	त्र	त्र	त्र	त्र	त्र

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

jña • ज्ञ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONJUNCT

jña

ज्ञ

Sound cue: ज् + ज

A common cluster in words such as jñāna.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ज्ञ	ज्ञ	ज्ञ	ज्ञ	ज्ञ	ज्ञ
ज्ञ	ज्ञ	ज्ञ	ज्ञ	ज्ञ	ज्ञ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

śra • श्र

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONJUNCT

śra

श्र

Sound cue: श् + र

A common cluster in words such as śrī.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

श्र	श्र	श्र	श्र	श्र	श्र
श्र	श्र	श्र	श्र	श्र	श्र

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

pra · प्र

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONJUNCT

pra

प्र

Sound cue: प् + र

A frequent initial cluster and verbal prefix shape.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

प्र	प्र	प्र	प्र	प्र	प्र
प्र	प्र	प्र	प्र	प्र	प्र

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

sta • स्त

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONJUNCT

sta

स्त

Sound cue: स् + त

A common cluster across many Sanskrit words.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

स्त	स्त	स्त	स्त	स्त	स्त
स्त	स्त	स्त	स्त	स्त	स्त

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

tva • त्व

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONJUNCT

tva

त्व

Sound cue: त् + व

A common abstract-noun and pronoun cluster.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

त्व	त्व	त्व	त्व	त्व	त्व
त्व	त्व	त्व	त्व	त्व	त्व

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

dya · द्य

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONJUNCT

dya

द्य

Sound cue: द् + य

A common cluster in words such as vidyā.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

द्य	द्य	द्य	द्य	द्य	द्य
द्य	द्य	द्य	द्य	द्य	द्य

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip



Basic Sanskrit words

Now connect letters into meaningful units. Read the IAST, identify vowel signs and conjuncts, then write the whole word with even spacing.

गुरु फल मतिर्

Before you begin

- Say the word before writing it.
- Trace the full word without lifting the pencil unnecessarily.
- Check every mātrā and conjunct before repeating from memory.

Word practice 1

Read IAST, say the meaning, trace the full Devanāgarī word, then copy it.

aśva

अश्व

horse

Trace

3 times

अश्व	अश्व	अश्व
------	------	------

Copy

6 spaces

agni

अग्नि

fire

Trace

3 times

अग्नि	अग्नि	अग्नि
-------	-------	-------

Copy

6 spaces

Word practice 2

Read IAST, say the meaning, trace the full Devanāgarī word, then copy it.

jala

जल

water

Trace

3 times

जल	जल	जल
----	----	----

Copy

6 spaces

phala

फल

fruit

Trace

3 times

फल	फल	फल
----	----	----

Copy

6 spaces

Word practice 3

Read IAST, say the meaning, trace the full Devanāgarī word, then copy it.

vana

वन

forest

Trace

3 times

वन	वन	वन
----	----	----

Copy

6 spaces

gaja

गज

elephant

Trace

3 times

गज	गज	गज
----	----	----

Copy

6 spaces

Word practice 4

Read IAST, say the meaning, trace the full Devanāgarī word, then copy it.

rāma

राम

Rāma

Trace

3 times

राम	राम	राम
-----	-----	-----

Copy

6 spaces

sītā

सीता

Sītā

Trace

3 times

सीता	सीता	सीता
------	------	------

Copy

6 spaces

Word practice 5

Read IAST, say the meaning, trace the full Devanāgarī word, then copy it.

guru

गुरु

teacher

Trace

3 times

गुरु	गुरु	गुरु
------	------	------

Copy

6 spaces

mātā

माता

mother

Trace

3 times

माता	माता	माता
------	------	------

Copy

6 spaces

Word practice 6

Read IAST, say the meaning, trace the full Devanāgarī word, then copy it.

pitā

पति

father

Trace

3 times

पति	पति	पति
-----	-----	-----

Copy

6 spaces

deva

देव

deity

Trace

3 times

देव	देव	देव
-----	-----	-----

Copy

6 spaces

Word practice 7

Read IAST, say the meaning, trace the full Devanāgarī word, then copy it.

yoga

योग

yoga

Trace

3 times

योग	योग	योग
-----	-----	-----

Copy

6 spaces

namah

नमः

salutation

Trace

3 times

नमः	नमः	नमः
-----	-----	-----

Copy

6 spaces

Word practice 8

Read IAST, say the meaning, trace the full Devanāgarī word, then copy it.

pustaka

पुस्तक

book

Trace

3 times

पुस्तक	पुस्तक	पुस्तक
--------	--------	--------

Copy

6 spaces

kamala

कमल

lotus

Trace

3 times

कमल	कमल	कमल
-----	-----	-----

Copy

6 spaces

Word practice 9

Read IAST, say the meaning, trace the full Devanāgarī word, then copy it.

bāla

बाल

child, boy

Trace

3 times

बाल	बाल	बाल
-----	-----	-----

Copy

6 spaces

bālā

बाला

girl

Trace

3 times

बाला	बाला	बाला
------	------	------

Copy

6 spaces

Word practice 10

Read IAST, say the meaning, trace the full Devanāgarī word, then copy it.

sūrya

सूर्य

sun

Trace

3 times

सूर्य	सूर्य	सूर्य
-------	-------	-------

Copy

6 spaces

candra

चन्द्र

moon

Trace

3 times

चन्द्र	चन्द्र	चन्द्र
--------	--------	--------

Copy

6 spaces

Word practice 11

Read IAST, say the meaning, trace the full Devanāgarī word, then copy it.

mitra

मतिर्

friend

Trace

3 times

मतिर्	मतिर्	मतिर्
-------	-------	-------

Copy

6 spaces

gr̥ha

गृह

home

Trace

3 times

गृह	गृह	गृह
-----	-----	-----

Copy

6 spaces

Word practice 12

Read IAST, say the meaning, trace the full Devanāgarī word, then copy it.

nadi

नदी

river

Trace

3 times

नदी	नदी	नदी
-----	-----	-----

Copy

6 spaces

bhārata

भारत

India

Trace

3 times

भारत	भारत	भारत
------	------	------

Copy

6 spaces

Digits 0-4

Trace each digit, then fill the empty cells.

0 • śūnya

०

०	०	०	०	०	०

1 • eka

१

१	१	१	१	१	१

2 • dvi

२

२	२	२	२	२	२

3 • tri

३

३	३	३	३	३	३

4 • catur

४

४	४	४	४	४	४

Digits 5-9

Trace each digit, then fill the empty cells.

5 • pañca

५

५	५	५	५	५	५

6 • ṣaṭ

६

६	६	६	६	६	६

7 • sapta

७

७	७	७	७	७	७

8 • aṣṭa

८

८	८	८	८	८	८

9 • nava

९

९	९	९	९	९	९

Mixed letter review

Write without tracing. Check the reference map only after each row.

Vowels

a ā i ī u ū

Gutturals

Check after writing: अ आ इ ई उ ऊ
ka kha ga gha ṇa

Palatals

Check after writing: क ख ग घ ङ
ca cha ja jha ṇa

Retroflex

Check after writing: च छ ज झ ञ
ṭa ṭha ḍa ḍha ṇa

Dentals

Check after writing: ट ठ ड ढ ण
ta tha ḍa dha na

Labials

Check after writing: प फ ब भ म
pa pha ba bha ma

Check after writing: प फ ब भ म

Mixed word review

Write without tracing. Check the reference map only after each row.

aśva horse

Check after writing: अश्व

guru teacher

Check after writing: गुरु

pustaka book

Check after writing: पुस्तक

sūrya sun

Check after writing: सूर्य

mitra friend

Check after writing: मित्र

bhārata India

Check after writing: भारत

My handwriting milestone

Return to any page whenever a form needs more practice.

अक्षराभ्यासः

akṣarābhyāsaḥ · letter practice

I completed the Devanāgarī Handwriting Practice Book.

learner

date

Design basis and further guidance

- **Cambridge Sanskrit, Devanagari Practice A4.** The trace-then-copy progression and top-line alignment convention informed this book's original practice grids. cambridge-sanskrit.org
- **NCERT, Vidya Pravesh.** Its foundational-stage guidance on pre-writing lines, curves, outline tracing, and fine-motor development informed the warm-up sequence. ncert.nic.in
- **Originality note.** All page layouts, wording, practice sequences, and vector guides in this book are original. No scanned workbook pages or third-party letter illustrations are reproduced.

KEEP GOING

Next, copy one short Sanskrit sentence per day. Preserve the headline, vowel-sign placement, and even spacing between words.